



DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
DEPARTMENT OF MECHANICAL ENGINEERING
USAF ACADEMY, COLORADO

27 October 2023

HQ USAFA/DFME
2354 Fairchild Drive, Suite 6L-159
USAF Academy CO 80840

Dear Colleague

I am inviting applications from qualified officers interested in serving as the **Permanent Professor and Head of the Department of Aeronautics** at the United States Air Force Academy (USAFA), Colorado.

The Dean of the Faculty has appointed me to chair an ad hoc search committee to evaluate candidates for the position. *Colonel Jean-Philippe Peltier* (Permanent Professor and Head, Department of Foreign Languages and International Programs), *Colonel Justin Joffrion* (Permanent Professor and Head, Department of Economics and Geosciences), *Colonel Rose Tseng* (Permanent Professor and Head, Department of Physics and Meteorology), and *Dr. Devin O'Dowd* (Associate Professor of Aeronautics and Propulsion Discipline Director, Department of Aeronautics). *Professor Robert Canfield*, Distinguished Visiting Professor from Virginia Tech will review and validate our process from outside the USAFA faculty.

The Permanent Professor

Permanent Professors ensure the integration, continuity, and evolution of the Academy's instructional program by providing senior institutional leadership, strategic direction, organizational stability, and oversight of the course of instruction. Their special terms of service reflect the demands of maintaining the highest quality academic, military, athletic, and leadership programs at a military service academy, which is also an accredited institution of higher learning, and their long tenures guide the institution through the turbulence caused by rapid rotational assignments.

By law, USAFA is authorized 25 Permanent Professors; they are appointed by the President, with the advice and consent of the Senate. Permanent Professors, other than the Dean of the Faculty (a brigadier general), hold the grade of colonel. They remain part of the Regular Air or Space Force, but they are not on the active duty list. A Permanent Professor may remain on active duty until age 64 with the approval of the Secretary of the Air Force. Upon retirement, any Permanent Professor whose service in that role has been long and distinguished may be retired in the grade of brigadier general, without the pay of that grade. Otherwise, Permanent Professors have no opportunity to promote beyond the grade of colonel. Likewise, it is extraordinarily rare to return to the line of the Air Force. *For all these reasons, to become a Permanent Professor is to embark on a new career, not just a new assignment.* See USAFAI36-3532 – Permanent Professors for additional details, provisions, and 10 U.S.C. references.

The Permanent Professor and Head of the Department of Aeronautics leads 30 military and civilian faculty members who maintain, teach, and assess the aeronautical engineering courses to 700 cadets each academic year. The Department of Aeronautics plays host to three research centers (the Aeronautics Research Center, the High-Performance Computing Research Center, and the Hypersonic Vehicle Simulation Institute); the Permanent Professor oversees 30 civilian and contractor staff conducting real-world research in those centers. The Permanent Professor serves on USAFA's senior academic council, establishing institutional policies and overseeing curricular changes, and supports the Air Force by creating and promoting faculty and cadet research projects in support of national priorities. In addition, Permanent Professors participate in the total course of instruction across USAFA, advising and otherwise serving the faculty, Dean, and Superintendent

Qualifications

To be appointed Permanent Professor, an officer must possess an outstanding military record and hold the grade of Lieutenant Colonel or higher (officers with a line number for Lieutenant Colonel may apply). Candidates will have a doctorate degree and demonstrated excellence as an Airman- and/or Guardian-scholar.

The most qualified candidates will possess the following attributes and experiences:

- Possess a dissertation-based PhD from an in-residence program
- Experience leading organizations
- Knowledge of aeronautics, aerospace, and/or related scholarly works
- Ability to communicate with senior leaders on aeronautical engineering curricular and research matters
- Experience with science, technology, and engineering-focused research activities in the field of aeronautics
- Experience as an educator, particularly at the undergraduate level and experience developing aeronautical engineering curriculum
- Experience in the development, testing, and/or operation of DoD systems in the aerospace domain
- Experience integrating curriculum and/or developmental experiences across multiple organizations

Application Process

This announcement invites the submission of an application used to identify finalists for an in-person interview process. Following interviews, a candidate will be recommended to the USAFA Superintendent and, on approval, nominated for appointment. If you are interested in and feel you are qualified for the position, we invite you to submit an application consisting of:

- A **cover letter** (max 2 pages) containing your statement of interest, view of the position and role of Permanent Professor, and a summary of relevant qualifications.
- A complete **Curriculum Vitae** tailored to this role
 - Academic credentials (include transcripts for all graduate programs)
 - A list of scholarly publications and presentations
 - A bullet summary of key research experience
 - Details of university level experience as an educator
 - Membership in professional societies
- An account of your military experience, including:
 - Biography
 - A bullet summary of your military career with emphasis on leadership experience
 - A current SURF
 - Copies of your OPRs for the past 10 years
- Any personal data you wish to include
- The names and contact information of three to five referees, including your present and immediate past commander or supervisor

Please compile these items into a **single, well-organized, flat pdf file** and send it to me via email at cory.cooper@afacademy.af.edu. **In order to meet our timeline, your application must be received no later than 30 NOV 2023.** I will reply to confirm receipt.

Please note submission of the application is only an expression of interest and not a commitment to assignment availability. Prior to completion of the search process, we will coordinate with the nominee's current command and the Air Force Personnel Center on assignment timing and availability.

If you need additional information or have any questions, please feel free to contact me via the email above, by phone at 719-333-6266 (DSN 333). In the meantime, **to help ensure the search committee has notified all potentially qualified applicants, please acknowledge receipt of this letter via reply email NLT 15 NOV 2023 and indicate whether you intend to apply for the position.** We hope you decide to apply, and we look forward to considering your application.

Sincerely

CORY A. COOPER, PhD, Colonel, USAF
Permanent Professor and Head
Department of Mechanical Engineering